

Write to a Diary File

To keep an activity log of your MATLAB® session, use the [diary](#) function. When enabled, diary logs entered commands, keyboard input, and text output from the Command Window to a UTF-8 encoded text file on your system.

For example, if you have the array `A = [ 1 2 3 4; 5 6 7 8 ]` in your workspace, you can use the `diary` function to save `A` and its contents to a text file.

1. Enable logging using the `diary` function. Optionally, you can name the log file `diary` creates. For example, enable logging and specify the log filename as `my_data.out`. `diary` creates the file `my_data.out` and starts recording all entered commands, keyboard input, and text output from the Command Window.

```
diary my_data.out
```

2. Display the contents of the array you want to save, for example, `A`. You also can display a cell array or other MATLAB class.

```
A
```

```
A =
```

```
     1     2     3     4
     5     6     7     8
```

3. Disable logging.

```
diary off
```

4. Display the contents of `my_data.out` using the `type` function.

```
type my_data.out
```

```
A
```

```
A =
```

```
     1     2     3     4
     5     6     7     8
```

```
diary off
```

5. Open the diary file `my_data.out` in a text editor and remove extraneous text, if desired.

See Also

Functions

[diary](#) | [type](#) | [evalc](#)

Topics

[Modify Command History Settings](#)

YOU MIGHT ALSO BE INTERESTED IN

